Support for parents/caregivers

Parents/caregivers sometimes find that they can benefit from the additional support of the various services provided at the Aisling Centre. This can be discussed with the play therapist.

"Her time with the play therapist has definitely benefited her-she is back to the happy confident eight year old she used to be"

Support for schools

It can be difficult for schools to meet the needs of children dealing with the emotional difficulties that some children may experience as a result of loss. Aisling Centre can help by working onsite to offer care and support through play therapy to children experiencing loss.

"it's not that the problems have gone away (family separation) but you can see that they are able to manage the situation better and are less anxious and withdrawn"

Standards

The Aisling Centre adheres to the BACP (British Association of Counselling and Psychotherapy) ethical framework for good practice in Counselling and Psychotherapy.

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Find out more

To find out more about services available at the Aisling Centre visit our website (details below) or register to receive e-updates. You can also follow us on Facebook & Twitter.

Where can you find us?

Aisling Centre
37, Darling Street
Enniskillen
Co Fermanagh
BT74 7DP

How can you contact us?

Drop in: 9am - 5pm Monday to Friday
Telephone: 028 66 325811
Email: info@theaislingcentre.com
Website: www.theaislingcentre.com

Follow us on

Patron

Adrian Dunbar

Registered with the Charity Commission for NI - NIC101096
Limited Company Registration No – NI 27011
BACP Registration No - 101666

Emergency contact telephone numbers:

Gateway Team: 028 7131 4090
Lifeline: 0808 808 8000
Emergency Services: 999
GP Out of Hours Services: 028 7186 5195
Samaritans: 08457 90 90 90
Childline: 0800 1111

Design & Print by www.csgwd.com March 17

Aisling centre
Hope Healing Growth

Children Coping with Loss
Counselling through Play Therapy



When you need someone to talk to...

We are here to listen

Your local Counselling, Psychotherapy and Well-Being Service

www.theaislingcentre.com

What is play therapy?

Play therapy is a way of helping children make sense of painful experiences as they explore difficult emotions and learn new coping skills.

Play is a natural, non-verbal form of expression for a child. Using a range of creative interventions - toys/games, art, storytelling, writing/poetry, sand, puppets etc - play therapists use play to help children express their feelings, thoughts and experiences.

Play therapy enables children to communicate at their own level and at their own pace in a way that is safe and comfortable for them.

"I like the toys (the play therapist) doesn't get cross with me. I talk about (person who is gone) and sometimes I tell her funny things they used to do and we laugh"

Play Therapy at the Aisling Centre

Is available to children who are:-

- experiencing loss through bereavement, family separation or long-term illness
- aged 5+ and currently attending primary school

Priority will be given to

- children coping with recent loss (ie within the last 3-years)
- children experiencing the loss of an immediate family member or a significant other
- Older children (i.e. children in primary 7)

What does the Aisling Centre offer?

At the Aisling Centre we have a qualified, experienced team of therapists. They are dedicated to supporting you wherever you are on life's journey.In a safe and welcoming space your child can communicate freely and in confidence about the things that are troubling them over a period of weekly one hour sessions.

Parents/caregivers are the most important people in the lives of children and we encourage you to play a supportive part in the process. We will hold regular review meetings with you to ensure the best possible outcomes for your child.

Play therapy is available at the Aisling Centre and from some outreach venues including schools and GP Practices.

Would play therapy help my child?

Feeling broken hearted is as common in children as adults.

Through play therapy children can:-

- Receive emotional support
- Feel listened to and have their loss acknowledged
- Learn to better understand and express their thoughts, emotions and feelings
- Begin to make sense of difficult life experiences
- Develop new coping skills
- Experience reduction in anxiety and increased self-esteem and self-confidence
- Implement changes in behaviour
- Enjoy improved family and social relationships

"(the play therapist) helped me to understand my feelings and not to worry about it when I felt funny"

How do I make an appointment?

Drop into reception at the Centre, telephone, email or visit our website. All queries will be answered promptly and you will be invited to fill in a simple counselling request form.

Sometimes your child's teacher or your GP or other professional may suggest play therapy for your child. They can make a referral with your permission, on your behalf.

Once we receive your request for play therapy for your child we will write to you. Appointments are offered as quickly as possible but there may be a waiting list at busy times.

What happens next?

First your child will be given an appointment for an initial interview. At the initial interview you and your child will meet with the play therapist. Here you will have an opportunity to discuss your child's needs and problems and to talk about what it is that has brought you to the Aisling Centre

We understand that both child and parent/ caregiver can find the initial interview daunting and we will endeavour to ensure that it is positive experience for both of you. During the interview the therapist will help you decided if play therapy at the Aisling Centre is the best option for your child at this time. If not, we will work with you to find more appropriate support.

If we agree that play therapy is appropriate and may benefit your child, the therapist will arrange a regular appointment time with you. Play therapy sessions are normally once a week for an agreed number of weeks.